

Aligning Incentives with Client Goals in Outcome-Based Contracts

Shared Risk and Reward

Structure the contract to align incentives for both parties, with the consulting firm receiving higher compensation for exceeding targets and potential penalties for underperformance. This risk-reward model fosters a true partnership and shared commitment to achieving the desired outcomes.

BAIN & COMPANY

BCG

Higher Compensation for exceeding targets

Potential Penalties for Underperformance

Milestone-based Payments

Link payments to achieving pre-defined milestones or interim outcomes rather than solely relying on input-based billing. This approach ensures that the consulting firm is compensated as progress is made towards the final goals, providing motivation and accountability.

GOAL

Gain-sharing arrangements

Implement gain-sharing models where the consulting firm receives a percentage of the financial benefits or cost savings achieved for the client. This model directly aligns the consulting firm's compensation with the value delivered to the client.

Consulting firm's compensation

Aligns with

Value delivered to client

Performance Incentives

Incorporate performance-based incentives, such as bonuses or success fees, for exceptional achievement or exceeding predetermined targets. These incentives further motivate the consulting firm to strive for outstanding results.

Bonuses

Success Fees

Incorporate performance-based incentives

Commissions

Stock Options or Equity Grants

208